



Academic Integrity Policy

American World School — Online Programme

Purpose of This Policy

The purpose of this policy is to clearly articulate what is expected and disapproved of every learner in regard to academic performance. Integrity and honesty are central to the learning experience at American World School, and we cultivate an environment where students are encouraged to do their own work and think honestly — including in the online learning environment, where trust between student and Success Coach matters just as much as it does in person.

To embody academic integrity is to actively value:

- Intellectual honesty
- Truthfulness towards oneself
- Learning for the love of acquiring knowledge
- Other's creative and professional work

At American World School, we expect all of our online learners to demonstrate academic integrity in relation to their assignment submissions, Mastery Block work, assessments, peer-to-peer collaborative projects, group projects, and their overall behavior towards learning during Live Blocks and self-paced study.

What Is Academic Dishonesty?

Academic dishonesty is any action whereby an individual deceives others, intentionally or unintentionally, by taking academic responsibility and ownership for work that is not their own original creation, including but not limited to work completed with unauthorized assistance, excessive AI usage, or misrepresentation of sources.

Categories of Academic Integrity Violations

1. Malpractice

Any action that provides a learner with an unfair advantage over others, including:

- Accessing unauthorized materials during assessments
- Using prohibited resources, browser tabs, or technology during online examinations
- Tampering with grading systems or academic records on the learning platform

2. Plagiarism

The presentation of another individual's work, ideas, words, or intellectual property as one's own without proper and explicit acknowledgment. This includes:

- Copying text from sources without citation
- Paraphrasing ideas without attribution
- Self-plagiarism (submitting one's own previous work without disclosure)
- Purchasing or obtaining pre-written essays or assignments

3. Collusion

The act of a learner assisting another learner in committing malpractice. Examples include:



- Allowing any assignment or Mastery Block task to be copied that was assigned to be done independently
- Submitting an assessment on behalf of another learner
- Messaging, screen-sharing, or other forms of communication during an online assessment with the intention of sharing answers
- Sharing completed assignments with other students when independent work is required

4. Fabrication of Data

Falsifying, inventing, or manipulating research data, records, citations, or experimental results for any project or assignment submission. This includes creating fictitious sources or misrepresenting actual findings.

5. Theft

Unauthorized possession, distribution, or use of assessment materials, including obtaining test questions in advance, stealing answer keys, or sharing assessment content with other students.

6. Early or Unauthorized Access

Accessing tests, quizzes, assignments, or grading materials on the learning platform before they are officially released or without proper authorization.

7. Alteration

Altering a returned project, assignment, or assessment with the intent of deceiving the Success Coach about the learner's performance or to fraudulently claim additional credit.

8. Unauthorized Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI)

The unauthorized or excessive use of AI tools constitutes academic dishonesty. Specific violations include:

- Using AI to generate complete or substantial portions of essays, reports, or written assignments
- Employing AI to answer open-ended questions without proper disclosure
- Using AI to complete problem sets, coding assignments, or analytical work when independent thinking is required
- Submitting AI-generated content without significant original contribution or proper attribution
- Using AI during assessments or examinations without explicit permission

Permitted AI use:

- Brainstorming and ideation (with subsequent independent development)
- Grammar and spell-checking tools
- Research assistance (when properly cited)
- When explicitly authorized by the Success Coach for specific assignments

Students must disclose any AI assistance used in their work. When in doubt about appropriate AI use, students should consult their Success Coach before submission.

Online Assessment Integrity

Assessments delivered through the online platform carry the same expectations of honesty as any in-person assessment, with a few points specific to the online setting:

- Camera and identity verification: where a proctored assessment requires a camera to be on, students must remain visible for the duration of the assessment.



- No unauthorized devices or tabs: students may not use a second device, browser tab, or application to look up answers or communicate with others during a timed assessment unless explicitly permitted.
- No screen-sharing or recording: assessment content may not be shared, screen-recorded, or distributed to other students.
- Reporting irregular activity: a Success Coach who observes irregular activity during a live, proctored assessment may pause the session and flag it for review under this policy.

Procedures for Addressing Violations

Reporting Process

- The Success Coach or educator who has identified the act of academic dishonesty will complete the Academic Integrity Violation Report Form with detailed documentation of the incident.
- The completed report, along with all supporting evidence (copies of work, screenshots, witness statements, plagiarism detection reports, etc.), will be submitted to Mr. Benzakhir Faisal, Head of Schools, and/or Dr. Mohanalakshmi, Founder.
- The school administration will notify the student and their family within 48 hours of receiving the report.
- The student will be given an opportunity to respond to the allegations before final determination.

Investigation and Determination

The school administration will conduct a thorough investigation and make a determination based on the following criteria:

- Age and grade level of the learner: younger students may receive more educational interventions; upper-level students will face more serious consequences.
- Seriousness and scope of the violation: minor citation errors vs. wholesale plagiarism; single assignment vs. pattern of dishonesty.
- Intent of the learner: whether the violation was intentional or due to lack of understanding; evidence of premeditation or deception.
- Impact of the incident: effect on other students; academic and competitive advantages gained.
- Prior history of violations: first offense vs. repeat violations; pattern of behavior across courses or years.
- Student's response: and acceptance of responsibility.

CONTACT INFORMATION

For any questions regarding this policy, please contact:

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High School Success Manager — radhika@americanworldschool.org

Mr. Benzakhir Faisal
Head of School — benzakhir@americanworldschool.org

Dr. Mohanalakshmi
Founder — mohana.lakshmi@americanworldschool.org



Policy Effective Date: February 2026

This policy applies to students enrolled in the AWS Online Programme and will be reviewed and updated annually or as needed.

Kindly review, sign, and submit this document to confirm that you have read, understood, and agreed to the policies and guidelines outlined. Your signature and submission will serve as acknowledgement of your understanding and agreement to follow the stated policies.

Parent/ Guardian Name:
Date:

Parent/ Guardian Name:
Date:

Student Name:
Date: